

CBT-V2 — User Guide

The staff guide to running computer-based tests at your institution.

Administration portal for administrators and invigilators. Students sit their exams in the separate candidate application and do not log in here.

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1. Roles and what each can do

The portal has three staff roles. What you see in the left-hand sidebar depends on your role.

Capability	Superadmin	Admin	Invigilator
Dashboard	Yes	Yes	Yes
View students, faculties & courses	Yes	Yes	Yes
Add/edit faculties & courses; bulk-upload students	Yes	—	—
Create assessments	Yes	Yes	—
Manage <i>any</i> assessment	Yes	Own only	—
Manage staff accounts	Yes	—	—
Invigilator dashboard & live monitoring	Yes	—	Yes
Archived assessments	Yes	—	—
Audit logs	Yes	—	—
Settings	Yes	—	—

- **Superadmin** — full control over the whole system and its configuration.
- **Admin** — creates and runs their own assessments. Admins can see lists of students, courses and faculties but cannot edit those records; they can only open and control assessments they created.
- **Invigilator** — monitors live exams they have been assigned to. No setup or editing rights.

2. Logging in

1. Open the portal URL in your browser.
2. Enter your **email address** and **password**, then click **Continue**.
3. On success you land on the **Dashboard**.

If you see "*Incorrect details provided*", re-check your email and password. If you see "*We couldn't reach the server*", the exam server may be offline — wait a moment and try again. To sign out, use the **Logout** button at the bottom of the sidebar.

3. The dashboard

The dashboard greets you with your name and email and offers **Quick Actions**: Bulk Upload Students, Create an Assessment, and Create a Faculty. Use the left sidebar to navigate to any section at any time.

4. Setting up your institution (first-time setup)

Superadmin only — under *Settings* → *General*. Before creating assessments, set the basics so everything is labelled correctly:

1. **Institution Details** — institution name, short name/abbreviation, contact email, and a **logo** (PNG/JPG, recommended 256×256px). The logo and names appear in the sidebar and on generated documents.

2. **Academic Session** — set the current **session** (e.g. 2024/2025) and **semester/term** (First or Second).
New assessments default to these values, so keep them current.

Click **Save Changes** in each card. A sensible setup order is: **Institution** → **Faculties** → **Departments** → **Courses** → **Students** → **Staff** → **Assessments**.

5. Faculties and departments

Superadmin creates/edits; everyone can view. Faculties (and the departments inside them) are how students are grouped, so you can later assign whole cohorts to an exam.

Create a faculty — go to **Faculties**, click **Create Faculty**, and enter a code, name and short description. The table shows each faculty's code, name, description, number of departments and creation date. Click the pencil icon to edit a faculty.

Departments live under **Faculties** → **Departments** in the sidebar. Each department belongs to a faculty.

6. Courses

Superadmin adds; everyone can view. A course is a subject that can be examined.

1. Go to **Courses**.
2. Click **Add a course**.
3. Enter a course code, title and description, then **Add course**.

Use the search box to find courses by title, code or description. The list is paginated — use **Previous / Next** to move between pages.

7. Students

Superadmin manages; admins/invigilators can view and search. Students are added in bulk rather than one at a time.

Bulk-upload students

1. Go to **Users** (Students tab).
2. Click **Bulk Upload Students**.
3. Click **Download Upload Template** and fill in the spreadsheet with student details.
4. Choose the **faculty** and **department** the batch belongs to.
5. Select your completed file and click **Upload File**.

If any row in the file has an error (e.g. a duplicate), **no** students are uploaded — fix the file and re-upload the whole batch.

Bulk-upload passports (photos)

Click **Bulk Upload Passports** and upload a **.zip** of student photos. Each photo is matched to a student by registration number, so name the images accordingly.

Finding students

- **Search** by name, registration number, email or phone.
- **Filter** by level (100–500), faculty and department.
- Use **Clear Filters** to reset, and **Previous / Next** to page through results. Superadmins can click a student row to open their detail page.

8. Staff (administrators & invigilators)

Superadmin only — Users → Administrators. The Administrators tab lists all staff accounts with name, email, role, phone and enrolment date.

Create a staff member: click **Create Admin**, enter full name, email and a password, choose a role (Admin, Super Admin or Invigilator), and submit.

9. Assessments

The **Assessments** page is the heart of the portal. It lists every assessment with its course, due date, number of sections/questions, assigned students, total marks and status. You can:

- **Filter** with the tabs: *All Assessment, Not Started, Ongoing, Completed*.
- **Search** by title.
- (Superadmin) Toggle **Archived** to include archived assessments.
- Open an assessment you control by clicking its **Actions** link.

9.1 Creating an assessment

Superadmin or Admin — click *Create an Assessment*. A dialog asks for:

- **Course** — the subject being examined.
- **Session** and **Term** — default to your institution's current settings.
- **Instruction** — general instructions shown to candidates.
- **Total Marks** and **Status** — choose **Publish Now** to make it live, or **Save Draft** to keep working on it.
- **Start** and **End (due) dates**.

Click **Proceed to Questions** to continue, or **Cancel** to go back.

9.2 Adding sections and questions

An assessment is organised into **sections**, each holding questions of one type.

Add a section — in the right-hand panel click **Add a Section** and set a title, a description/instruction, the section type, and the default score per question. Section types:

- **Objective** (multiple choice) — one correct answer (A–D).
- **Multiple Select** — one or more correct answers (A–D).
- **Subjective** — short typed answers checked against accepted answers ("slots").
- **Theory** — long written answers; marked manually or by AI against an expected answer.

Add questions — with a section active, type the question, add options/answers, mark the correct one(s), and click **Add Question**. Notes:

- Objective/Multiple-select questions support up to **4 options** (A–D). Pick the correct option with the radio button (objective) or checkboxes (multiple select).
- **Subjective** slots accept comma-separated acceptable answers (e.g. `Ans 1, Ans 2`).
- **Theory** takes a single expected answer and is flagged for manual/AI marking.
- You can attach an **image** to any question (JPG/PNG) and preview how candidates will see it.
- Each section holds up to **60 questions**.

Use the numbered buttons in the side panel to jump between questions, **Add Question** to create more, or **Delete Section** to remove a whole section. Editing a saved question shows **Update Question** instead of Add. When finished, click **Submit Assessment**.

9.3 Bulk-uploading questions (from CSV)

For objective sections you can import many questions at once:

1. Make sure an **Objective (multiple choice)** section is active.
2. Click **Bulk Upload** and choose a **.csv** file with these columns: `question`, `option_a`, `option_b`, `option_c`, `option_d`, `correct_answer`, `score`.
3. The questions load into the section. If a column is missing or the file is malformed, nothing is imported and you'll get an error.

9.4 Configuring an assessment

Open an assessment to reach its control page. The top cards show **status**, **question count**, **total marks** and **time allocated**. Below, the controls (only editable by the assessment's owner or a superadmin) let you set:

- **Test Duration** — total time in minutes.
- **Test Status** — start / end / restart the exam (see 9.7).
- **Start Date** and **Due Date**.
- **Total Marks** and **Pass Mark (%)**.
- **Shuffle Questions** — toggle per section type so each candidate sees questions in a random order.
- **Browser Restrictions** — when enabled, the candidate app locks down the browser to help deter cheating; works with live violation tracking.

Each field has its own **Save** button.

9.5 Assigning students

On the right of the control page you choose who sits the exam:

- **Assign by level / faculty / department** — pick an action (Assign or Unassign), a level, and optionally a faculty and department, then **Proceed** to assign a whole cohort at once.
- **Assign a single student** — enter their registration number and click **Assign**.
- **Bulk assign / unassign** (for carry-over or borrowed-course students) — upload an **.xlsx** file of registration numbers. Use **Download template** to get the correct format.

9.6 Assigning invigilators

Invigilators must be attached to an assessment before they can monitor it. Use the **Invigilators** dialog on the assessment to add staff (with the invigilator role) and remove them again as needed.

9.7 Running the exam

The **Test Status** card drives the live exam:

- **Start Exam** — authorises the assessment so assigned candidates can begin (status becomes *Ongoing*).
- **End Exam** — closes the exam for everyone.
- **Restart Exam** — reopens an exam that was ended.

Until you click *Start Exam*, candidates see "Not cleared to start".

10. Live invigilation & monitoring

Invigilator or Superadmin — Invigilator in the sidebar. The **Invigilator Dashboard** lists the assessments you're assigned to. For each one it shows session/term, dates, total marks, and live counts of **total**, **submitted**, **in-progress**, **still-writing** and **locked** candidates, plus a per-student table with status and violation count.

Click **Monitoring** on an assessment to open the **live monitoring** screen. It connects in real time (a "Live" indicator confirms the connection) and updates as candidates act:

- See each candidate's **status** (writing, submitted, locked, disconnected), **online/offline** connection, live **progress** (answered / total), and **violation count**.
- Stat cards track totals, who's online, who has started, and who is locked.

Handling violations

When a candidate triggers a violation (e.g. leaving the exam window), it's counted live. Repeated violations can **lock** a candidate or trigger an **auto-submit**. To review:

1. Click **(n) View Details** in the candidate's Violations column.
2. Read the list of violations with timestamps.
3. To excuse one, click **Pardon** — a **pardon code** is generated. Give this code to the candidate so they can resume.

11. Marking and grading

From an assessment's control page, open **View/Mark Submissions**. The submissions list shows every candidate with reg number, level, auto-marking status, current score and whether marking is **finalized**. Click **Remark Assessment** to re-run automatic marking across all submissions.

Click a submission to open the **marking screen** for that candidate:

- Objective and multiple-select answers are **auto-marked** and shown as Correct/Wrong.
- For **subjective/theory** answers you see the candidate's response next to the expected answer. Mark each either **WRONG** (awards 0) or enter a **score** and confirm to award marks (up to the question's maximum).
- **AI Marking** (available on the cloud deployment) can grade written answers for you and attach feedback; you can still override any result.
- When done, click **Finalize Marking** to lock in the candidate's result.

12. Analytics and results

Analytics (control page → View Analytics) shows:

- **Pass Rate** cards: total students, passed, failed, auto-submitted, pass/fail rate, and the configured pass mark. Click **Download PDF** for a report.

- **Student Rankings:** a leaderboard with each student's score, percentage, rank and whether they were auto-submitted.

Generate Results / Entries (from the control page) lets you export:

- **Generate Submissions (Scripts)** — download raw submissions.
- **Generate Results** — export the result sheet as **PDF** or **XLSX**.

13. Archiving assessments

To take a finished assessment out of the active list, open it and click **Archive Assessment**. Archived assessments are hidden by default; superadmins can view them via the **Archived** toggle on the Assessments page or the **Assessments** → **Archived** sidebar item.

14. Audit logs

Superadmin only — Audit Logs in the sidebar. A searchable, paginated record of important actions across the system. Each entry shows the **actor**, **action** (create, update, focus-lost, reconnect, pardon-applied...), **entity**, **IP address** and **date**. Filter by action type, and click **View** for the full detail of any record.

15. Settings

Superadmin only.

- **General** — institution details and academic session (see section 4).
- **Appearance** — visual/theme preferences.
- **Security** — change your account password (enter current password, then the new one twice).
- **Backup & Sync** — synchronise data between the local exam server and the cloud. Push/pull individual collections or use **Push All / Pull All**. The most recently changed record wins on conflicts.
- **Database** — **permanently delete** records from selected collections (assessments, students, courses, groups, sub-groups, admins). This **cannot be undone**; the *Admins* collection is especially dangerous and rarely needed. After clearing, a results panel shows how many records were removed.

16. Tips & troubleshooting

- **A student isn't getting the exam** — confirm they're **assigned** (by cohort or reg number) and that you've clicked **Start Exam**.
- **Upload rejected** — student/question uploads are all-or-nothing. Use the provided template and check for duplicate or malformed rows.
- **Candidate is locked out** — open live monitoring, review their violations, and **Pardon** if appropriate, then share the pardon code.
- **Can't edit an assessment** — only the creator (or a superadmin) can change an assessment's settings; others see the controls greyed out.
- **AI marking unavailable** — AI marking only runs on the cloud deployment, not the local exam server.

- **Don't see a menu item** — visibility depends on your role (see section 1).
- **Always keep the academic session/term current** in Settings so new assessments are labelled correctly.